

Attention Review

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Reason to Disregard (Out of Scope)

- Attention mechanisms in large language models (e.g., BERT Transformers)
- Attention disorders
- General linguistic usage (e.g., lack of attention to something / pay attention to something)

Major Themes:

- ***Investor Attention***

Measurements:

- search-based measures of investor attention (e.g., google search index, co-search behavior like the search spillover from the focal firm to its suppliers)

Mechanisms:

From my understanding, "attention" functions as a latent mechanism. Below can draw investors' attention, and then in turn alter their further investing behavior and decision-making. (stimulus - attention - behavior)

- visibility on social platforms
- advertising appearance
- information disclosure (e.g., cash flow disclosure, earnings announcement)
- voluntary disclosure
- International political events

- ***Stakeholder Attention***

Whom:

- Stakeholders refer to entities that have shared interests with the focal firm (e.g., investors, financial analysts, suppliers, alliances)

Mechanisms:

- Signals from the focal company will change stakeholders' behavior (e.g., a strong earnings announcement by the focal firm can make alliance partners more willing to collaborate)

- **Consumer Attention**

For consumer attention, I feel it is different from investor attention. Most of the literature uses consumer attention as a dependent variable (DV).

Measurements:

- Plenty of papers use eye-tracking to measure consumers' attention

Mechanisms:

Below can attract consumers' attention, thus facilitating purchase behavior.

- advertising design (e.g., layout, content)
- location-based advertising
- background music
- product price / risk
- AI can bias consumer attention

- **Manager Attention**

Whom:

- Most of studies focus on CEOs

Mechanisms:

Managers have limited attention, and what they focus on influences the firm's strategic priorities, in terms of the following aspects:

- firm decision-making
- firm performance

- corporate social responsibility; environmental, social, and governance (ESG)
- **Organization Attention**

Similar to the manager attention, based on the attention-based view of the firm, a firm's development is guided by its attention. External information attracts firms' attention and influences their actions.

 - pay attention to emergent social issues
 - response to media pressure
 - take care of gender diversity
- **Cognitive Attention**

There is a small body of literature on cognitive attention. These studies identify general patterns that do not target a specific audience but instead apply broadly across individuals.

Such as, how people pay attention to the following:

 - stimulus (e.g., negative feedback, threat)
 - facial expression (e.g., fearful expression, eye-size)
- **Employee Attention**

How to better help employees focus in order to improve work efficiency.

 - music background
- **Platform User Attention**

The literature on platform user attention mainly approaches the topic from two perspectives.

From the perspective of users:

 - how can users seek attention from other users (e.g., being an online hater)

From the perspective of platform governance:

 - for example, how to balance user limited attention between addictive content (interesting but no knowledge) and high quality content (learn knowledge but boring)

- ***Product User Attention***

How product design features or flaws influence users' attention during the usage process ?

- IT product (e.g., system interruption)

- ***Public Attention***

How public attention forces firms to take social responsibility and enables more effective government regulation.

- media pressure
 - effective regulation
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Related Theory:

- ***Signaling Theory***

- limited attention paid to signals

- ***Cognitive Niches View***

- explain selective attention

- ***Spillover Effects***

- attention spillover to related products / topics / assets
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